



FUNDING PROPOSAL

COMANCHE CONDITION ASSESSMENT & PHASED PRESERVATION PLAN

The document every larger grant, insurer and moorage partner asks for first.

\$70,000

TOTAL REQUEST

Executive summary

The Foundation will commission a qualified marine surveyor and historic-preservation consultant to produce a professional condition assessment of Comanche: a compartment-by-compartment survey, ultrasonic hull-thickness sampling, prioritized stabilization needs, a phased restoration sequence with order-of-magnitude cost ranges, and an indexed photographic record. The assessment converts “the ship needs everything” into a credible, sequenced, fundable preservation plan.

Statement of need

Comanche has not been hauled out since 2013. The Foundation, formed in 2025, inherited a vessel with decades of volunteer maintenance but no current professional survey, no baseline hull-thickness data and no written preservation sequence. Every capital funder, marine insurer and marina the Foundation approaches asks for exactly that document. Without it the board cannot rank stabilization work by urgency, cannot set credible budgets for haul-out or machinery projects, and cannot demonstrate stewardship capacity to larger grantmakers.

Project description

A licensed marine surveyor (SAMS/NAMS accredited) will conduct a full in-water survey with UT gauging at representative hull stations, supported by a historic-preservation consultant experienced with steel museum vessels. Deliverables: (1) written condition assessment; (2) stabilization priorities ranked by safety and urgency; (3) phased restoration plan with cost ranges suitable for capital applications; (4) compartment-indexed photo record archived in the Foundation data room; (5) a public summary for the website. The board will adopt the plan by resolution within 60 days of delivery and use it to sequence the Foundation’s haul-out, machinery and power-system proposals.

Goals & measurable objectives

- One professional written condition assessment with UT gauging data delivered.
- A stabilization priority list ranked by urgency and safety.

- A phased, costed restoration plan suitable for capital-grant applications.
- A compartment-indexed photographic baseline (minimum 600 images) archived.
- Board adoption of the plan by resolution within 60 days of delivery.

Timeline

Month 1	Solicit three surveyor/consultant quotes; board selects by resolution.
Month 2	On-site survey, UT gauging and photo documentation.
Months 3–4	Draft assessment, stabilization priorities, phased scope and cost ranges.
Month 5	Board review; plan adopted by resolution.
Month 6	Public summary published; plan seeds next applications.

Budget

Marine surveyor — in-water survey and written report	\$14,000
Ultrasonic thickness gauging (diver/technician, ~120 stations)	\$9,000
Historic-preservation consultant — phased plan and cost ranges	\$12,000
Dive services, staging, access and tank/void entry prep	\$6,500
Photo documentation and data-room archiving	\$3,500
Report production, public summary and web exhibit	\$2,500
Direct costs	\$47,500
Project management & administration (8%)	\$3,800
Contingency (25%)	\$12,825
Total project cost	\$64,125
Amount requested (rounded)	\$70,000

Budget lines are order-of-magnitude planning figures for a 133 ft / 295 GT steel vessel on Puget Sound, deliberately conservative so the funded scope can be delivered in full; they are replaced with vendor quotes at application. Unused contingency is returned or reallocated with funder approval. Partial funding is welcome and combinable with other sources.

In-kind and match. Volunteer coordination, board time, vessel access, crew support for survey days (est. 240 volunteer hours).

Evaluation

- Deliverables received and reviewed by the board and an independent maritime professional.
- Plan adopted by board resolution (date recorded in minutes).
- Plan cited in at least two subsequent funding applications within 12 months.

Funder fit

- National Trust Preservation Funds
- Valerie Sivinski Fund (Washington Trust)
- 4Culture Preservation Special Projects
- Maritime Washington NHA
- Private family foundations

Sustainability

The assessment is a one-time product with a multi-year shelf life; the Foundation will update it after each haul-out and keep the photo baseline current through volunteer documentation days.

Organization overview

Tug Comanche Historical Rescue Foundation (EIN 39-5018917) is a Washington nonprofit based in Auburn, Washington, listed on the IRS Publication 78 data list as eligible to receive tax-deductible charitable contributions (deductibility code PC). The Foundation preserves the historic vessel Comanche — laid down in 1944 as the U.S. Navy ocean tug ATA-202, later USS Wampanoag and Coast Guard cutter WMEC-202 — and operates her as a living platform for maritime heritage, hands-on education, youth mentorship, restoration-skills exposure, veteran and mariner storytelling, Puget Sound stewardship, and community service. Comanche is one of the last operational WWII museum ships in the world, still moving under her own power with an all-volunteer crew. The organization is governed by a volunteer board of directors and delivers its programs through volunteers, maritime-trades mentors and community partners.

Vessel history & significance

Comanche is a rare surviving example of a WWII-era U.S. Navy auxiliary ocean tug. Completed in 1944 and commissioned as ATA-202, she was named USS Wampanoag in 1948 and later served as the U.S. Coast Guard cutter WMEC-202 before becoming known as Comanche. Her current U.S. Coast Guard Certificate of Documentation (Official Number 647250; IMO 8991786) records a steel-hulled, mechanically propelled vessel of 133.4 feet registered length, 33.1-foot breadth, 17.7-foot depth and 295 gross tons (ITC), hailing port Seattle, Washington. She is propelled by two Cleveland Diesel 12-cylinder diesel-electric main engines driving a single screw, and holds a world record as the last ship still steered by deck-tube chain rudder control.

Legal & operating boundary. Comanche does not hold a U.S. Coast Guard Certificate of Inspection for commercial passenger service. No grant funds, fees or donations are or will be used for paid carriage, charters, towing, freight or any underway commercial service. Public programs take place alongside the pier; cruises occur only in partnership with other nonprofit and community organizations, never as a charter, and the Foundation retains control of the vessel at all times.

Contact: Wesley Weaver, Secretary — info@tug202.org — tug202.org · The web version of this proposal, with the latest figures, is at tug202.org/grants/condition-assessment.